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INTRODUCTION

The scenario has been presented as such:

“You have just been selected as a Student Digital Ambassador at your college. Your role is to help your peers navigate the digital world — from creating professional online profiles, to communicating safely and responsibly online. Your first assignment is to build a Digital Literacy Portfolio that you will present to the faculty committee and share with your batch.”

The project report presented here is a compilation of the reflections from the various tasks completed for this project. Across the project, the tasks have been completed as instructed, and my own reflections and learnings presented.

TASK 1

For this task, I used Canva to make my infographic, which provided user-friendly interfaces and a variety of templates, making it easier to create a visually appealing and structured design without requiring advanced design skills.

The infographic highlights key aspects of digital literacy, including its definition, the importance of maintaining a professional online presence, and the role of useful digital tools for students. It is designed to be simple, informative, and engaging so that students can quickly understand the concepts and apply them in their daily academic and online activities.

One interesting aspect of this task was learning how visual elements such as icons, colors, and layout can influence how information is perceived. At the same time, one challenge I faced was selecting the most relevant information and presenting it concisely without overcrowding the design. Overall, this task helped me understand the importance of combining clarity with creativity while communicating information digitally.

TASK 2

I created profiles on GitHub, LinkedIn, and Kaggle to establish a professional digital presence that will help me later on, to showcase my skills. GitHub is primarily used for hosting and managing code repositories, allowing students to showcase their projects and track their learning progress. LinkedIn serves as a professional networking platform where students can build their identity, connect with professionals, and explore career opportunities. Kaggle is a platform focused on data science and machine learning, where users can practice with datasets and improve analytical skills.

Over the next four years, I plan to use GitHub to regularly upload projects and document my technical growth. On LinkedIn, I aim to maintain a professional profile, share achievements, and connect with peers and industry experts. Through Kaggle, I intend to explore data-related concepts and participate in beginner-level challenges. Together, these platforms will help me build a strong and credible digital portfolio for future academic and career opportunities.

TASK 3

I used HackerRank and Google Forms to practice coding on specific websites, and collaboration tools in the form of Google Forms. On HackerRank, I created an account and began working on Python exercises. I completed a beginner-level challenge and earned a badge, which made the experience engaging and motivating. It helped me brush up on my previous knowledge, and the game-like interface and the concept of 'streaks' is something that I'm sure will motivate me to get on the site more and practise.

In addition, I created a Google Form as a digital literacy awareness quiz. I created a quiz with common questions to test understanding and awareness; also, I got myself familiar with the various tools and templates provided by Google Forms, and how the response sheet and answers system works.

These platforms will be very useful academically. HackerRank will help me strengthen my coding skills through regular practice, which is essential for my coursework and future technical roles. Google Forms and similar tools will assist in creating surveys, collecting feedback, and working efficiently in group projects.

TASK 4

In today's digital environment, poor communication can lead to misunderstandings and missed opportunities. For example, one of my friends' hastily written, poorly formatted email came off as rude to his professor. He'd requested an increase in marks which would make him pass the paper in that course; instead, the rude email did the opposite effect, and the professor only scolded him for that mishap.

This incident could have been avoided only if he had taken the time to write his email properly and use a correct tone to request for the increase in marks. Thus, it is important that we know how to write emails and formal letters, especially to potential employers, managers, or our professors. In a time when we remain mostly online, it is important to know the distinction between informally texting our friends and formally messaging our elders.

TASK 5

While researching phishing attacks, what surprised me the most was how realistic and convincing these scams can appear. Even individuals who are aware of cyber threats can fall victim due to urgency and pressure created by such messages; and while the messages may seem obvious when being studied, the situation is completely different when being actually faced with it.

Researching deeper into this topic has made me more aware about verifying links and having to check the authenticity of emails. I am definitely trying to make it into a habit, and to change the habit of taking quick decisions when dealing with online links. After all, phishing victims are often people who believe that they are safe, only to be duped within the blink of an eye.

CONCLUSION

Working on this project allowed me to get into a deeper dive about the topic and engage with the concept of digital literacy beyond just theoretical means, putting my learnings into practice. It helped me understand that digital literacy is not just about using tools, but also about being aware, responsible, and professional in digital environments.

Digital literacy is not just about awareness- that is a common misconception. It means being aware, and to know when and where and how to apply our skills. Through the various tasks given- making the infographic, writing the emails, doing the case study- all of it has sharpened my skills and made me understand this better. It has encouraged me to build a stronger and more meaningful digital presence.